DAILY DEBRIEF 9 (02/25/2026)

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Global equities push higher as AI-disruption fears ease and investors rotate back into megacap tech, with semis and software leading while defensives lag. Nvidia posts another strong beat and upbeat outlook but fails to spark sustained after-hours gains. Treasuries edge weaker after soft 5Y demand, the dollar slips, gold and silver stay firm, bitcoin nears $70K, and crude wobbles on a large US inventory build. Consumer confidence tops estimates as regional manufacturing remains mixed, Fed officials signal patience, and looming 15% tariffs keep attention on PPI, claims and the staying power of AI capex.

Stocks

USA	Europe	APAC
S&P 500 +0.81%	DAX +0.76%	Hang Seng +0.66%
NASDAQ +1.26%	Euro Stoxx 50 +0.93%	Nikkei 225 +2.20%
Dow Jones +0.63%	FTSE 100 +1.18%	CSI 300 +0.60%

As of 7:07 PM ET

Commodities

Energy	Metals	Agriculture
WTI Crude +0.34%	Spot Gold +0.02%	Corn +0.80
Brent Crude +0.11%	Spot Silver -1.15%	Coffee -0.23%
HH Nat Gas +0.56%		Cotton +0.93%

As of 7:07PM ET

Financial Market Monitor

Market Overview

U.S. equities closed higher with megacap tech, semis and software leading as AI-disruption fears continued to fade. Nvidia delivered another beat and upbeat outlook but failed to sustain after-hours momentum. Treasuries edged weaker following soft 5Y auction demand, the dollar slipped modestly, gold rose 1% and silver jumped 4%, bitcoin rallied toward $70K, and WTI crude dipped 0.3% after a sharp U.S. inventory build.

Equities

Strength centered on semis, memory, software and select high-beta names, alongside banks, payments, networking and entertainment. AI-linked shares stabilized as partnership narratives helped counter recent disruption concerns. Laggards included homebuilders, machinery, transports, staples and parts of energy. Earnings dispersion remained elevated, with upbeat guidance and capital return announcements driving notable winners while cautious outlooks and margin headwinds weighed on select consumer and tech names.

Macro & Rates

Consumer confidence topped expectations, though regional manufacturing surveys were mixed with softer shipments and new orders. Price components in Fed surveys suggested moderating pressures. Fed officials reiterated a patient, data-dependent stance, reinforcing expectations for rates to remain on hold near term. Trade uncertainty lingers as the administration prepares to formalize a 15% tariff rate where appropriate.

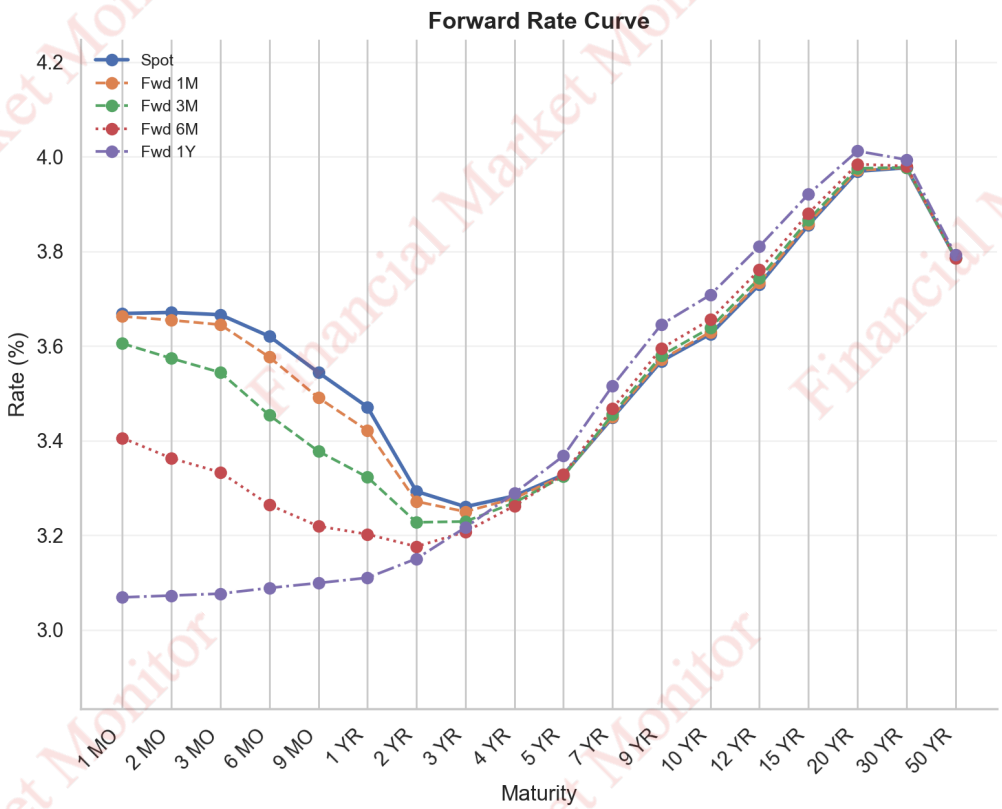
FX & Commodities

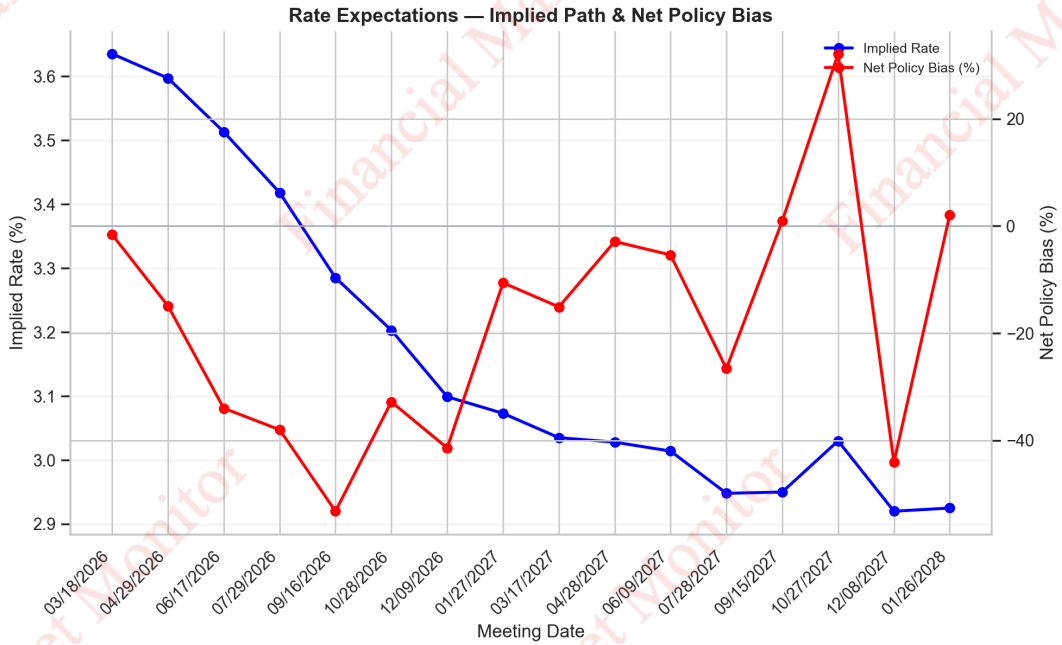
The dollar index eased slightly. Precious metals extended gains on continued hedging demand, while bitcoin surged before trimming advances. Crude wavered as a nearly 16M barrel rise in U.S. inventories offset expectations for seasonal demand and potential supply disruptions.

Geopolitics

U.S.-Iran diplomacy shows tentative progress ahead of renewed talks, though military positioning and tariff developments keep the broader backdrop fluid. Investors remain focused on trade policy shifts and the durability of AI-driven capital spending.

Financial Market Monitor





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